Fast All-vs-All Conjunction Screening

Screening every catalog object against every other in seconds to minutes, for any propagator

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Executive summary

Space Data Network (SDN) screens the full public catalog, 32,514 objects, all-vs-all over three days in 19 s with SGP4 on ordinary processors, and in 21 s with a GPU. With numerical high-precision orbit propagation (HPOP) under the full force model of section 5, it takes 31 CPU-hours, 1.9 hours on 16 dedicated cores, almost all of it propagation; search and refinement take 48.6 s. The screen finds every pair that comes within 5 km, and reports each close approach's time (TCA), miss distance, relative speed and maximum collision probability. The measurements were taken on one 28-core workstation, in Node.js and in a standard web browser. In WasmEdge, the runtime SDN nodes use, the SGP4 screen takes 23 s. Every run on one catalog and propagator reports the same conjunctions.

Five design choices produce that speed:

1. **A spatial grid proposes pairs; the module decides.** At every 60 s step, a uniform grid finds the pairs that could be close among the 528.6 million, on a GPU (WebGPU) or in the WebAssembly (WASM) conjunction module on CPU threads. The module re-tests each candidate in f64 and refines it. Every reported number comes from the module.
2. **Each trajectory bounds its own motion.** Between two samples, an object cannot stray from a straight line by more than a bound its trajectory source computes. A pair whose straight-line approach stays farther apart than the threshold plus both bounds cannot close, and is discarded without further work. The bound holds for any force model, maneuvers included.
3. **One propagator per run, in time windows.** A run screens either SGP4 element sets or one numerical propagator's trajectories, never a mix. Long screens run as consecutive windows, so memory stays at one window's trajectories while the next window is propagated.
4. **Load once, move records unchanged.** The catalog loads into the module once. A propagator's output passes into the conjunction module as the records it emitted, without re-encoding.
5. **Refinement proves, then solves.** Where the range of a pair provably has one minimum, Newton's method on the range rate finds it in about ten evaluations.

The screen reproduces the module's single-call screen where both can run. On 4,000 objects over one day, all 1,068 conjunctions match, with TCA within 0.64 ms and miss distance within 5 mm; the single call takes 32.9 s and the windowed screen 0.44 s.

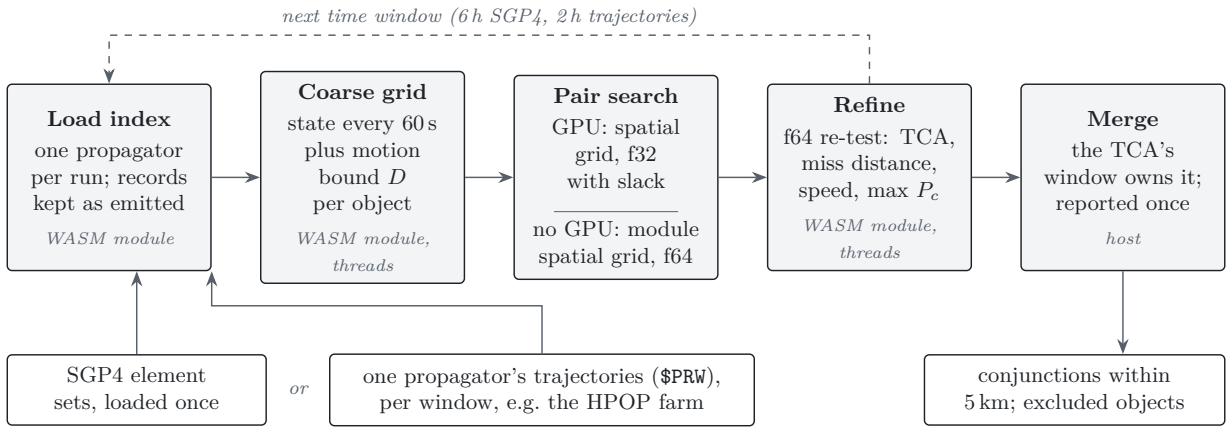
Against SOCRATES on the element sets SOCRATES itself used, TCA agrees within 0.5 ms and miss distance within 2.4 m for 95 % of cataloged pairs, the precision SOCRATES reports. Each event reports the covariance-free maximum probability. With an empirical model of element-set prediction error, events also carry a covariance-based probability. It is labeled calibrated only where held-out precise orbits confirm the covariance: LEO 600 to 800 km, 13,088 of the 292,516 three-day conjunctions. There, screening on the uncertainty region missed 0–0.4 % of true collisions, against 2.7–16 % for a probability threshold of 1e-4, whose probabilities a large covariance dilutes (section 7). The model[1] adds 1.1 s to the 19 s screen (section 7).

1 The problem

An all-vs-all screen compares every object with every other: $n(n-1)/2$ pairs, 528.6 million for 32,514 objects. A three-day screen at 60 s steps evaluates each pair at 4,321 instants, about 2.3 trillion pair-steps. A close approach at 10 km/s relative speed lasts under a second inside a few kilometers, so a coarse test that misses it loses the event.

The module's existing single-call screen (`screen_catalog`) uses a perigee/apogee prefilter and a k-d tree per time step. It holds every encounter of the window in WASM linear memory, at most 2 GiB. It runs out of memory above about 7,000 objects for a one-day window[2].

2 Pipeline



The host code (JavaScript) moves records between the module and the GPU and contains no physics. The conjunction module, the SGP4 implementation, the HPOP propagator and the epoch-state converter are WASM modules. They are built with the SDN Module SDK and run unchanged in a browser, in the WasmEdge runtime and in its Docker image[3].

Stage	Where	Precision	Decides
Coarse grid	WASM module, threaded	f64 computed, f32 stored	Sample states and bounds
Pair search	GPU, WebGPU compute	f32 with 0.01 km slack	Candidates only
Pair search without a GPU	WASM module, threaded	f64	Candidates only
Re-test and refinement	WASM module, threaded	f64	Every reported result
Window merge	Host	Exact comparisons	Which window owns each TCA

3 The candidate test

Self-bounded motion

Let h be half the coarse step (30 s at 60 s steps). For a sample of an object at step k, with position r and velocity v, the trajectory source supplies a bound D such that the true position stays within D of the straight line:

$$|\mathbf{r}(t_k + \tau) - \mathbf{r}_k - \mathbf{v}_k\tau| \le D \quad \text{for all } |\tau| \le h.$$

Two objects can then come within the threshold d during the interval only if the straight-line relative path does so within d + D_1 + D_2. The test computes the clamped closest approach of the relative straight line over [−h, h] and compares it with that limit. A pair that fails the test at every step of an interval cannot close in it.

Each source kind computes D from what it knows:

Source	Bound	Basis
SGP4 element set	½ A h², with A = 1.05 μ / r²_min and r_min = |r| − |v| h, floored at 6,000 km	SGP4 motion is unpowered; the 5 % margin covers J2 (0.16 % at the surface) and drag
Chebyshev trajectory (PPE) from any propagator	½ A h² + (J + G) h + P	A bounds the position series' second derivative using |T_k″| ≤ k²(k² − 1)/3. J and P sum velocity and position jumps where intervals meet. G is the gap between the velocity series and the position series' derivative

The trajectory bound uses only the coefficients, so it holds for any force model and for impulsive maneuvers that appear as interval jumps. A native test checks it against the trajectory itself every 0.1 s around samples taken every 7 s. The trajectory is a 7,000 km orbit interpolated as a propagator would export it, with a 5 m/s maneuver at an interval boundary. Tested at h = 30 s and h = 90 s, the bound was never exceeded, and away from the maneuver it was at most 1.34 times the true deviation[2].

Spatial grid

Testing all 528.6 million pairs at every step is wasted work: almost all pairs are thousands of kilometres apart. At each step, an object's straight-line segment over [−h, h], widened by d/2 + D, gives an axis-aligned box. Two objects can pass the straight-line test only if their boxes overlap, so a search over overlapping boxes drops nothing the test would pass.

The boxes go into a uniform grid whose cell is the 99th-percentile box edge. Each overlapping pair is counted once, in the cell holding the low corner of the two boxes' overlap. The few boxes that span four or more cells on an axis, such as fast perigee passes, are tested against every object. The same grid runs in two places:

- **On a GPU**, in three WebGPU compute passes per step. The first inserts each box into its cells, hashed into one lock-free list per slot. The second has each object walk its cells' lists. The third tests the large boxes.
- **Without a GPU**, in the WASM module on CPU threads: in a browser without WebGPU, in Node.js, or in WasmEdge on an SDN node or in Docker.

Either way, the grid proposes exactly the pairs an all-pairs test would. On the full catalog over three days, the GPU grid proposed the same 2,678,533 candidates as an all-pairs GPU kernel did.

SDN nodes run modules in WasmEdge compiled ahead of time. That needs SDN's patched WasmEdge 0.16.4: the stock compiler mishandles offsets on atomic memory instructions, and with it the full-catalog search hung in its second window. Interpreted WasmEdge is about 75 times slower.

Two precisions, one decision

The GPU evaluates the test in f32. Positions near 7,000 km round to about 0.5 m in f32, so the GPU adds 0.01 km of slack and proposes a superset. The module repeats the test in f64 for every candidate. Over one

day of the full catalog the GPU proposed 829,990 candidates and 828,910 passed the f64 test. Over three days the GPU proposed 2,678,533 and the CPU grid, which applies the f64 test directly, 2,675,123; both refine to the same conjunctions.

Refinement

Passing steps of a pair join into encounters. Each encounter is refined by the same TCA search the single-call screen uses, so both report the same TCA.

For most encounters the search first proves that the range has one minimum in its window, then solves for it directly. Let A bound both objects' accelerations over the window; for SGP4 this is 1.05 μ / r²_min, the bound of the candidate test. With T the window's half-width and Δr, Δv the relative state at its middle:

$$|\Delta\dot{\mathbf{r}}| \geq |\Delta\mathbf{v}| - \varepsilon - AT, \qquad |\Delta\mathbf{r}| \leq |\Delta\mathbf{r}_{\mathrm{mid}}| + |\Delta\mathbf{v}|T + \tfrac{1}{2}AT^2.$$

ε (1 m/s) allows for a source's velocity differing from the rate of its position. If q = |Δr|max A / |$\Delta\dot{\mathrm{r}}$|min² < 1, the squared range is convex on the window. Its one minimum is then the root of the range rate f = Δr · Δv, and Newton steps of −f / |Δv|² converge by a factor q or better per step. About ten state evaluations reach the root to the resolution of a Julian date, about 47 µs.

Where the proof fails, for example a slow pair that stays close for minutes, the search samples the range every 5 s and refines each minimum it brackets with golden-section search.

Probability uses the Alfano maximum[4]. When a refine call would stage more than the module's 16,384-event output limit, the host splits it in two.

4 One propagator per run

A run screens one propagator's output. A resident index holds either mean elements, evaluated with the module's SGP4, or trajectories from one generator, identified by the Chebyshev ephemeris (PPE) record's `EPHEMERIS_SOURCE`. The module refuses an index that mixes them (`mixed-propagators`).

Chebyshev series per interval are the standard form for precomputed ephemerides. NASA's SPICE toolkit stores them that way: SPK data types 2, 3, 14 and 20 hold Chebyshev coefficients for position, velocity or both[11], and JPL distributes its planetary ephemerides as Chebyshev polynomials fit to positions and velocities in 32-day intervals[12,13]. Deprit, Pickard and Poplarchek recommended Chebyshev approximation for compressing ephemerides because it minimizes the largest error over the interval[14]. A Chebyshev interpolant of degree n is within a factor 2 + (2/π) log(n + 1) of the best polynomial approximation of that degree[15]. The same form serves spacecraft and catalog orbits: onboard ephemeris generation[16] and orbit information with continuous state and covariance at a predetermined accuracy[17]. Open-source readers include jplephem (MIT License,[18]) and ANISE (Mozilla Public License 2.0,[19]); NAIF's toolkit is free to use under its own rules[11].

Trajectories reach the module as their propagator exported them. The HPOP module's export is a size-prefixed `$PRW` record per object. The conjunction module's index preparation takes those records on its `trajectories` port without re-encoding, and the request carries only each object's identity. Trajectories in TT or TDB map to UTC linearly between their converted interval ends, using the vendored ERFA library[5]. TDB − TT is evaluated once per minute and interpolated, exact to about 1e-14 s.

5 Time windows

A long screen runs as consecutive windows; the merged result equals one screen of the whole span:

- A conjunction belongs to the window that holds its TCA.
- A TCA within the refinement tolerance of a shared edge is reported by both windows and kept once.

Window length trades memory for per-window overhead. A day of HPOP's trajectories is about 240 KB per object, so HPOP screens in 1-hour windows: about 390 MB of trajectories for the full catalog, which the

conjunction module indexes in 1.05 GiB of its 2 GiB. SGP4 windows reuse one index loaded at the start, so they are longer (6 hours).

Tests check four windows against a single screen for both propagators. The SGP4 case uses CelesTrak element sets that include an object SGP4 cannot propagate. The HPOP case uses crossing orbits integrated by HPOP, passed through the `trajectories` port[2,29].

The HPOP propagation farm

1. The epoch-state module converts each element set into a GCRF state at its epoch: SGP4 at zero elapsed time, then TEME to GCRF through ERFA. This is the OMM-to-numerical handoff of the companion paper[1], section 4.
2. HPOP resident instances, at most 1,024 objects each, integrate those states on worker threads with the force model below. Objects are dealt round-robin into about two instances per worker, so element sets of every age spread evenly.
3. Each window, every instance exports the window and the records go to the browser unchanged. The next window is exported while the current one is screened.

HPOP	Setting
Gravity	EGM2008 to degree and order 70, in Earth-fixed axes from IERS Earth orientation[20,22]
Sun, Moon and planets	Sun, Moon, Venus, Mars and Jupiter from JPL DE440s[21]
Drag	NRLMSISE-00[23]
Radiation pressure	Cannonball with a conical Earth shadow; Earth albedo and infrared, Knocke model on 15° elements[24]
Tides and relativity	IERS 2010 solid tides and relativistic terms; FES2004 ocean tides to degree and order 30[22,25]
Earth orientation and space weather	As released at the screen's start: IERS finals2000A rows to the day before, the last one held; GFZ Kp, ap and F10.7, then NOAA SWPC's latest daily report with its 3-day forecast, the last day held[26]
Drag coefficient	$Cd \cdot A/m = 2B^*/\rho_0$ from each element set's B*, with SGP4's reference density $\rho_0 = 2.461 \times 10^{-5}$ XKMPER kg/m² per Earth radius, XKMPER = 6,378.135 km[27]
Reentry	HPOP ends a trajectory at 100 km geodetic altitude; an object is screened through the last full window before its reentry
Assumptions	$Cd \cdot A/m = 0.01$ m²/kg for the 6,069 element sets with $B^* \leq 0$; $Cr \cdot A/m = 0.02$ m²/kg for all 32,514 objects
Integrator	Runge–Kutta–Fehlberg 7(8), relative tolerance 10^{-12}, steps of at most 300 s, restarted only where the space weather changes[28]
Export	Chebyshev series of degree 12 on 300 s segments of TT, fitted to the integrator's dense output; each segment states its largest difference from the integrator's accepted states

The tolerance, the segment length and the resident integration were measured[29]:

- **Tolerance.** Against 10^{-14}, the integration's own error after three days is 0.1 m at 400 km, 1.2 m at 700 km sun-synchronous and 0.18 m for Molniya. At 10^{-11} it is 6 to 9 m in LEO.
- **Segment length.** A degree-12 series resolves about four cycles per segment. 300 s keeps the 70 × 70 field's shortest LEO terms, with periods near 80 s; over 600 s, the terms above degree 35 leave centimetre fit errors. Over four days the exported series stay within 0.31 mm of the integrator's dense output in LEO and 0.18 mm for Molniya.
- **One integration.** A resident object takes the same steps as one HPOP request for that object. From a day before its epoch to three days after, the two agree within 0.05 mm in LEO, 9 µm for Molniya and 9 nm for GPS and geostationary orbits.

HPOP integrates each object from its element epoch, so the first window carries that catch-up: 55,578 object-days from the element epochs to the screen's start, against 97,542 for the three days screened. HPOP drops cached intervals that end before the requested window, so an instance holds about one window per object.

6 Results

All runs used the Space-Track GP catalog of 30 September 2026, 32,514 objects[6]. Screens started 2026-10-01T00:00Z, with a 5 km threshold and 60 s coarse steps, on a Mac Studio with 28 cores and 27 module threads. GPU runs used headless Chrome with Metal for WebGPU. The workstation was shared with other work (1-minute load average 15–65 on 28 cores), so times are upper bounds.

Full catalog, three days

Propagator	Pair search	End to end	Sampling and search	Refine	Conjunctions
SGP4, 12 × 6 h	CPU, Node.js	19.1 s	9.7 s	6.6 s	292,516
SGP4	CPU, WasmEdge (AOT, SDN patches)	22.9 s	11.9 s	8.7 s	292,516
SGP4	GPU	21.3 s	6.1 + 2.3 s	7.2 s	292,516
HPOP, 72 × 1 h	CPU, Node.js	6,964 s	33.8 s	14.8 s	288,524

- For each propagator, every run reports the same conjunctions with the same TCA and miss distance.
- **SGP4's** remaining time is sampling: 4,321 steps × 32,514 SGP4 evaluations. On the GPU path the module samples (6.1 s) and the GPU searches (2.3 s).
- **HPOP's** time is propagation: 110,642 CPU-seconds on 16 worker threads, 0.72 s per object-day, 36 % of it the catch-up from element epochs to the screen's start. The table's end-to-end time is that CPU time on 16 dedicated cores plus the 48.6 s of search and refinement on 8 module threads; on the shared workstation (1-minute load average median 40, maximum 62) the screen took 9,294 s[29].
- The two propagators report different conjunctions. Of HPOP's 288,524, 39,486 (14 %) are also in the SGP4 screen, the same pair with TCAs within 10 minutes; on those, TCAs differ by a median of 1.2 s and miss distances by 670 m. The share falls from 21 % of the first day's conjunctions to 9 % of the third's. Neither result is a measure of accuracy (section 7).

Step size

The candidate test is exhaustive at any step, so the step size trades sampling against candidates. SGP4, three days:

Step	Candidates	CPU search	CPU end to end	GPU end to end	Conjunctions
5 s	4,748,277	92.1 s	102.0 s	98.6 s	292,516
30 s	1,414,694	17.8 s	29.9 s		292,516
60 s	2,675,123	9.7 s	19.1 s	21.3 s	292,516
120 s	17,116,089	10.0 s	39.4 s		292,516

Every step size reports the same conjunctions, with miss distances within 2 mm. TCAs differ by up to 173 ms, but only on flat minima, where the miss distance is the same. A 5 s screen samples 12 times as often and finds nothing more. Shorter steps cost sampling; longer steps give larger bounds and more candidates. 60 s is near the optimum.

How the time came down

Three days, SGP4, CPU search in Node.js, same host:

Change	End to end	Refine
Dense TCA scan around every minimum	131.4 s	114.3 s
Unimodal proof, golden-section search	63.9 s	45.6 s
Newton steps on the range rate	55.3 s	38.4 s
The same solve for each fast encounter's first pass	34.7 s	17.6 s
SGP4 state read without a lock; element sets converted once	25.2 s	12.7 s
Refinement work shared in small chunks; events built in parallel	19.1 s	6.6 s

Every row reports the same 292,516 conjunctions. On the GPU path, replacing the all-pairs kernel with the grid cut the GPU search from 8.5 s to 2.3 s.

The first version also sent the whole catalog with every call. Loading it once into the module cut one day of the full catalog from 266.7 s to 55.4 s, with the same 77,667 conjunctions.

Agreement with the single-call screen

Objects, window	Single call	Windowed, CPU search	Conjunctions	Largest difference
2,000, 0.1 day	1.1 s	0.08 s	23 of 23	TCA 0.16 ms, miss 0.6 mm
4,000, 1 day	32.9 s	0.44 s	1,068 of 1,068	TCA 0.64 ms, miss 5 mm

On the 2,000-object case the CPU search and the GPU found the same 424 candidates and 23 conjunctions, in Node.js, WasmEdge and a browser. Differences from the single call come from refinement starting from different coarse brackets, and sit inside the module's parity tolerances of 10 ms and 10 cm.

Validation findings

7 Uncertainty and probability of collision

The companion paper[1] sets the conditions this screen respects, in its sections 4, 6 and 11:

- An OMM supplies no covariance. The initial uncertainty of an OMM-seeded HPOP trajectory, including this paper's HPOP runs, is unknown: no validated representation of it exists.
- A probability of collision requires relative-state uncertainty with independent calibration and stated cross-correlation, geometry and hard-body-radius assumptions.

Every event reports the Alfano maximum: the largest probability any covariance size could give for the reported miss distance and combined hard-body radius[4]. It needs no covariance and serves as an upper bound. Each object's radius comes with its basis: supplied, half the catalog size, from the radar cross section, or the request default. No uncertainty is invented: an event carries covariance, and a covariance-based probability, only when a source supplied covariance or the empirical model below applies, and it states which. The work below follows the companion paper's three parts[8]:

1. Initial covariance
2. Propagation
3. Calibration on held-out evidence

Independent truth

Calibration needs reference orbits that SGP4 did not produce. SDN's reference-states module turns precise orbits into GCRF states at stated times, each with its stated uncertainty as covariance[10]:

- IGS final GPS orbits;
- ILRS orbits for LAGEOS-1/2, ETALON-1/2, Ajisai, Starlette, Stella, LARETS, WESTPAC, LARES and LARES-2;
- Sentinel-1C/1D precise orbits;
- Swarm A/B/C precise orbits.

Their frames are converted with IERS Earth orientation parameters. For 2026-08-02 to 15, this gives 48 objects. The conversion matches an independent pyerfa computation within 1 mm, and a Vallado textbook case within its printed precision.

An empirical error model, and its calibration

A model of SGP4 prediction error was built from 1.89 million element sets (2026-07-12 to 08-08), stratified by orbit regime and prediction age. It uses differences between consecutive element sets of the same object. Those differences are not truth, and the reference orbits show by how much:

- From 600 km up, under half a day, they understate the true along-track error 4 to 11 times, because consecutive fits share their error.
- Below 600 km they overstate it, by 10 to 90 times beyond a day.

The calibration gate scales each stratum's covariance on one week of reference orbits (08-02 to 08), then tests it on the next (08-09 to 15). It compares each error's Mahalanobis distance with χ^2 on 3 degrees of freedom, and every sample counts. A stratum is CALIBRATED only when all of these hold:

- its 1σ and 2σ containment are within 5 points of nominal;
- no more than 1 % falls outside 3σ;
- it has at least 30 samples from at least 3 objects.

LEO 600 to 800 km, prediction age	Samples (objects)	Inside 1σ / 2σ / 3σ	Label
0 to 0.5 day	14,968 (4)	0.642 / 0.954 / 0.997	CALIBRATED
0.5 to 1 day	14,876 (4)	0.627 / 0.947 / 0.996	FAILED
1 to 2 days	31,327 (4)	0.647 / 0.943 / 0.997	CALIBRATED
2 to 3 days	31,805 (4)	0.636 / 0.922 / 0.994	CALIBRATED
3 to 5 days	58,981 (4)	0.701 / 0.960 / 0.997	CALIBRATED
5 to 7 days	49,187 (4)	0.728 / 0.965 / 0.991	CALIBRATED
Nominal		0.683 / 0.954 / 0.997	

Every other stratum is UNCALIBRATED:

- **GPS and the other MEO strata fail**, for example 0.37 / 0.70 / 0.89 for LAGEOS-1/2 and LARES-2 within half a day. GPS element sets carry per-satellite along-track offsets of −1.6 to +3.8 km.
- **The other LEO bands have only one or two reference objects.**
- **GEO, eccentric and beyond-GEO orbits have no independent truth here.**

The labels hold for these objects in this week.

Covariance probability on screened events

With the scaled model, element-set screens give each event's objects the covariance of their stratum at the TCA's prediction age. The event then reports the selected method's probability, Foster's by default[9]. Each event is labeled:

- the covariance as synthesized from the empirical model;
- the two objects' errors as independent;
- calibrated only when both objects' strata passed the gate.

On the three-day full catalog the screen found the same 292,516 conjunctions:

- 288,105 received a covariance probability;
- 13,088 of those are calibrated;
- refinement took 7.8 s instead of 7.0 s, and the run 19.6 s instead of 18.5 s.

Events outside the model keep the Alfano maximum. These are a negative or too-old prediction age, or a stratum the model lacks.

Propagated and fitted covariance

- **Propagation.** HPOP resident instances accept an initial covariance P_0 per object and return $P(t) = \Phi\ P_0\ \Phi^T + Q$, with the state transition matrix of the full force model. Q is a declared white-acceleration process noise, inertial or radial-transverse-normal, given as a spectral density and discretization interval. It is recorded in the trajectory (SDS 1.232.0). The state transition matrix matches finite differences, and Q matches its closed form.
- **Orbit determination.** Fits publish their formal covariance as an OCM. The OCM lists the noise models, weighting, observations used, process noise, a priori and convergence criteria, with biases neither estimated nor considered and no consider parameters. It is marked Uncalibrated.
- **HPOP covariance, calibrated in part.** It was checked the same way as the empirical model, for this paper's HPOP screen product: an element-set epoch state with P_0 measured at the epoch, then HPOP with the full force model of section 5 and the space weather released on the element set's day. A white-acceleration Q was fitted by maximum likelihood on the fit week; a regime kept $Q = 0$ where P_0 alone passed more fit-week strata[29].
  - **LEO 600 to 800 km, 0 to 0.5 day and 1 to 3 days: CALIBRATED with P_0 alone.** P_0 carried through HPOP's state transition matrix predicts the along-track growth, 1.3 to 17 km, within 11 %.
  - **LEO 600 to 800 km, 0.5 to 1 day: FAILED.** 75 % of the samples fall inside 1σ, 7 points above nominal.
  - **LEO 600 to 800 km beyond 3 days: FAILED.**
  - **GPS: FAILED at every age.** The normal error stays within 0.15 km for a week, while the along-track error grows to 36 km RMS at 5 to 7 days, against 16 km predicted. Started from the independent reference state instead, the same force model's along-track error after 6 days is 0.2 km (median), and 1.0 km with the radiation-pressure coefficient doubled; started from the element set it is 8.4 km. The along-track error is the epoch state's.
  - **Other bands: INSUFFICIENT**, except MEO 2,000 to 10,000 km within half a day: FAILED.
- **Orbit-determination covariance is not calibrated.** Covariance supplied in an OEM or OCM enters conjunction assessment as supplied covariance and keeps the source's calibration label.

Agreement with SOCRATES

SOCRATES is CelesTrak's public conjunction screen[7]. The replay used the top 300 rows of its 2 October 2026 maximum-probability report, from 179,398 rows. Each pair was reassessed from the element sets SOCRATES used for it, and the report and every input are hashed. The days since epoch agree to SOCRATES's printed precision, which confirms the inputs are identical.

Group	Rows	TCA median / p95 / max	Miss distance median / p95 / max
Cataloged pairs, faster than 10 m/s	112	0.4 / 0.5 / 24 ms	0.38 / 2.4 / 6.6 m
Pairs with an object numbered 100000 or above	126	0.4 / 4.2 / 7.6 ms	0.58 / 20.8 / 61 m
One formation pair, 0 to 5 m/s	62	19 / 69 / 363 ms	0.26 / 0.47 / 0.51 m

SOCRATES prints range to 1 m and speed to 1 m/s, so the cataloged pairs agree to its reported precision. Every fast miss difference over 20 m involves an object numbered 100000 or above, mostly Starlink, and the published inputs do not show why.

Maximum probability is about nine times lower here at a 10 m combined radius. That matches SOCRATES using larger, object-specific radii, which it does not publish: a combined radius of 30 m (median) would reproduce its values. For the formation pair, a short-term encounter does not hold for either computation, so the probabilities are not comparable.

Screening rules compared

Probabilistic, bounded-set and admissible-set screening compare as follows, on cases built from real SGP4 errors against the held-out reference orbits:

- two different objects' errors in one stratum make one encounter;
- each encounter is placed head-on and at a 90° crossing;
- synthetic true misses are added from 0 to 5 km;
- a collision is a true miss within 20 m.

The three rules alert as follows:

- **Probabilistic:** Foster's probability $\geq$ 1e-4.
- **Bounded set:** the 99.73 % relative ellipse comes within 20 m.
- **Possibility:** min-joined χ^2 possibility per object, alerting unless the necessity of no collision reaches 0.9973. Possibility and necessity are not probabilities.

The results, in the calibrated strata (10,000 cases a row):

Rule	Missed collisions, head-on	Missed collisions, crossing	False alerts at 1 km miss	False alerts at 2 km miss
Probabilistic	2.7 %	16 %	6 to 7 %	0 %
Bounded set	0.2 %	0.4 %	21 to 45 %	0 to 4.5 %
Possibility	0 %	0 %	69 to 89 %	4 to 24 %

- **Probabilistic.** Along-track uncertainty here is 0.6 to 3 km, so a true collision's probability averages only 0.002 head-on and 0.0006 crossing. This is dilution, and it is what hides the collisions the probability rule misses.
- **Possibility.** It missed none in calibrated strata, at the cost of the most false alerts. In uncalibrated strata it missed up to 8 %, so it is only as sound as its declared uncertainty.
- **Disclosure.** The baselines and cases were chosen independently of the TEAG and ESPF authors' implementations, and no TEAG or ESPF code was run.

8 Limits

Limit	Effect
SGP4 sampling	About half of a 19 s screen: 140 million SGP4 evaluations
HPOP propagation	Over 99 % of the HPOP screen, 0.72 CPU-seconds per object-day
Catch-up from element epochs	The first HPOP window waits for every object to reach the screen start: 36 % of the object-days
Memory per window	About 390 MB of trajectories per 1-hour HPOP window, indexed in 1.05 GiB of the module's 2 GiB
HPOP coefficients	Drag from each element set's B*, 0.01 m²/kg where B* $\leq$ 0; one radiation-pressure coefficient for every object
One host	All timings from one shared 28-core workstation; the module gives the procedure for repeating them[2]
Calibration coverage	Covariance calibrated only in LEO 600 to 800 km (empirical model; HPOP to 3 days, except 0.5 to 1 day), for 48 reference objects in one week

Limit	Effect
Probability inputs	Combined radius and covariance shape differ from SOCRATES's unpublished ones

This paper reports computation speed, agreement between implementations and with SOCRATES on identical inputs, and covariance calibration where independent truth exists. It does not establish operational readiness or orbit accuracy; the companion paper[1] reports measurements of HPOP's accuracy in its sections 7 and 10.

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